

Day 4 — Sacred Groves

Module: Indic Ecology — Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Identify devarakāḍu and similar groves as biodiversity reserves.

Materials

- Notebook, pencils, drawing paper
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

The flow

Settle + chant (3 min)

Daily chant or breathing exercise.

Story recall (4 min)

Briefly recall yesterday's lesson by asking: *"What's one thing you remember from yesterday?"*

Today's idea (10 min)

- *devarakāḍu* (IAST: devarakāḍu; lit. "sacred grove (Karnataka, S. India)")
- Sacred groves are special little forests that people DON'T cut.
- Why? Because they believe a god, a sage, or an ancestor lives there.
- Animals and plants live safely in these groves.

Show a picture of a grove. *"This is a place where no one breaks a branch."*

Children draw a tiny forest with animals: birds, butterflies, deer. Add a small temple or shrine.

Activity (8 min)

A simplified version of *Sacred Grove (or Local Ecology) Mapping* (see activities/). Draw, sing, or act it out.

Wrap-up (3 min)

Each child shares one word that describes today.

Homework

(See homework.md.)

Teacher notes

- Citations belong in teacher notes only, not in student-facing material at this band.
- Keep new Sanskrit terms to one per lesson, repeated several times.
- If energy is low, swap the activity for free drawing.